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SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWEL, PAPER (PLASTIC WIPING)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification UU-T-598.

This description covers paper wiping towels intended for use in cleaning, wiping, and polishing of soft delicate surfaces such as plastic finishes or acrylic plastic sheets.

Salient characteristics:

Paper wiping towels shall be soft, highly absorbent, non-abrasive tissue. The towels shall have an area of not less than 247.5 square inches (1,596 cm^2) with the smaller dimension not less than 14-3/4 inches (375 mm). The towels shall be folded and shall be constructed of at least two plies with all plies securely joined by mechanical means normally used in the manufacture of these towels. Towels shall conform to the following physical requirements. The issue of each TAPPI test method in effect on the date of solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with the requirements.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Weight per unit area:		TAPPI T 410
Basis weight (24 x 36 - 500), avg., ± 5 percent	27 pounds	
Grammage, avg., ± 5 percent	44 g/m^2	
Tensile strength, avg. (min.)		
Cross direction (Dry)	12 oz/inch (131 N/m)	TAPPI T404 or T494
Cross direction (Wet)	3 oz/inch (33 N/m)	Test Method A
Absorptiveness rate 1/, avg. (max.)		
0.1 ml water	15 seconds	TAPPI T 432
0.1 ml oil	45 seconds	Test Method B
Total absorption, percent of dry weight, avg. (min.)		
Water	450 percent	Test Method C
Oil	175 percent	Test Method D

1/ Test to be performed on both sides of towel and results reported separately.

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Test Method A - Test for wet tensile strength according to TAPPI T 456, except that samples of towels shall first be placed in a 105°C oven for 4 minutes.

Test Method B - Test in accordance with TAPPI T 432 using 0.1 ml of white mineral oil, 80 - 90 S.U. (Saybolt Universal) viscosity, +30 Saybolt color, N.F. grade in lieu of water.

Test Method C - Condition the specimens in accordance with TAPPI T 402. Weigh each specimen of size 4 x 4 (± 1/8) inches, and immerse them in distilled water at 25°C for 3 minutes (± 10 seconds). Remove the specimens by lifting them at one corner until their surfaces are vertical to the floor, and allow the excess water to drain off for 60 ± 10 seconds. Place each in a tared weighing bottle and reweigh. Calculate the percent absorption to the nearest one percent as follows:

$$\text{Percent absorption} = \frac{\text{Wet weight} - \text{Dry weight}}{\text{Dry weight}} \times 100$$

Test Method D - Follow the procedures in Test Method C using oil as specified in Test Method B in lieu of water. Drain time for the immersed sample should be 20 ± 2 minutes.

Workmanship. The towels shall be soft, pliable, smooth, and clean. Towels shall not contain holes, tears, cuts, wrinkles, dirt, and foreign material which will adversely affect the appearance or serviceability of the towels.

Regulatory requirements. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Notes: TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, Technology Park/Atlanta, P. O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

DoD has waived coordination of this document.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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